Special Considerations

1. Mist is prescribed with oxygen therapy to liquefy secretions.
2. Humidified air may condense into water droplets on the inside walls of the tent, it is important to examine the child's clothing and bedding and change them as necessary to prevent chilling.
3. Electrical equipment used within or near the tent should be grounded properly.
4. It is preferable to monitor SpO2 (oxygen saturation) of patient continuously.
5. Avoid the use of volatile, inflammable materials such as oils, grease, alcohol, either and acetone near the tent.
6. Nurses should be knowledgeable about the location and technique for using a fire extinguisher.
7. For the baby in oxygen tent, toys selected should be such that they retard absorption are washable and will not produce static electricity, e.g. woolen and stuffed toys. This ensures baby's safety.

8. 3 Specimen Collection

8.3.1 Definition

A specimen may be defined as a small quantity of a substance or object which shows the kind and quality of the whole (sample).

Specimen collection defined as the collection of the specimen for the purposes of diagnosis, treatment and recovery.

8.3.2 Preparation of the clients:

- Explain the procedure to the patient. It helps to gain the client's trust and cooperation.
- When preparing the client the nurse's explanation should be clear, straight forward and complete.
- Be sure that the client has understood clearly and correctly the information.
- In case of collection of urine, instruct the client to wash the genitalia with soap and water and then rinse it in water before collecting the specimen.
- Instruct the client not to contaminate the outside of the bottle.
- Instructions to use gloves and other barriers as necessary.

8.3.3 Types of containers used for specimen collection

- All specimens are collected in clean and dry containers.
- Use containers with wide mouth.
- Sterile containers are used for culture.
- Wax lined disposable cups are used for sputum and stool specimens.
- Large containers are used for 24 hours urine specimens.
- Sterile test tubes are used to collect fluids.
- Clean slides are used to collect smears.
- No antiseptic solution must be present in the specimen bottle as they may hamper the growth of micro organism and thus obscure the results.

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